A repo is a contract, not a gallery.

What a serious codebase says about the people who maintain it — and why hiring managers should read it first.

10 slides · swipe

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Git history is the honest interview.

No cover letter survives open_pull_requests. The repo shows: what you finish, what you abandon, what you defend in review, what you delete without ceremony.

The CV claims.
The repo confesses.

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HIRING · WHAT I LOOK FOR · 3/10

The repo signals that predict fit.

01 Commits with reasons, not 'fix stuff'

02 PRs that argue from evidence, not taste

03 Decisions documented where the code lives

04 Tests that catch real bugs, not coverage theater

05 Postmortems or honest retros in the commit log

One of these misses and I keep reading. Two and I pass.

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What my repos say about me.

62

MCP tools in opencode-chrome, each traced to a real failure

45+

real projects on GitHub — Python, TS, Java, Rust, Lua

1

public postmortem for every major system I broke

github.com/Mukller — judge the scars, not the polish.

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Two kinds of GitHub profiles.

GALLERY

Demo museum

cloned boilerplates
green CI wallpaper
no decisions documented

CONTRACT

Working codebase

real user problem
tradeoffs recorded
failures kept in history

One shows you can follow a tutorial. The other shows you can own a system.

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If you're building your repo now.

Don't chase stars. Build one ugly thing for yourself, keep the commit history honest, and leave a README that teaches me how your thinking works. That's 90% of the interview.

**Ten real commits beat
a thousand tutorial forks.**

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If you're already senior.

Write the incident review you never got — the one about your worst production day, with logs. That single document outranks any framework list on the resume.

Seniority is evidence of survived failure.

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HIRING · WHAT I ASK · 8/10

The repo I want to hire from.

01 A real problem someone actually had

02 Decisions recorded at the boundary of doubt

03 Failure modes documented, not hidden

04 A runbook for the on-call you respect

If your repo has these, you skip the trivia round.

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Why repos beat resumes.

In an interview you perform calm. In a repo you leave traces. Hire from traces.

The best predictor of senior judgment is documented judgment under pressure.

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Let me see your repo.

If your GitHub reads like a contract — real problems, honest commit history, decisions at the edges — send it over. antonpetnitsky.com

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